with complaints, away you go to the Prince, and you speak up, you speak manfully and you speak well, and you would fight with any nobleman in the land rather than not see your people get justice. I had a piece of land near Beenaub (a town adjoining the village), it had belonged to my fathers before me. Two years ago a rascal got false witnesses, made out false title deeds, got a decision from the cazi (judge) and took my land from me; I upset the decision but could not get possession; and after the most vexatious lawsuits I was obliged to rebuy my own land, if you had had the village you would have gone at once to the Prince and obtained me justice." I should also tell you to enable you to understand all this that in the east there are two sorts of law, the one the written Mahommedan law, as interpreted by the cazi and the Mollahs (priests) and the other the decisions of the govt officers which ought to be equity. The govt is in almost all cases the executive and puts in force the decisions of the cazi; *when it pleases*. But these same cazis and Mollahs have become such an infernal set of scamps that people have as little to do with them as possible. I often to save myself trouble told the villagers to go to the cazi but they wont go. You may imagine the trouble I have with them from the affair of the kettle, and to which I must tell you that the inhabitants of these two villages are perhaps as unruly and troublesome a set as any in Persia, they are much such fellows as we had on the borders of Scotland two hundred years ago, most of them armed, many of them robbers on the high way, and the greater part of them wine drinkers. I have had but one case of robbing on the high way since I had the village. There were two of them engaged in the robbery (of a Turk Mousul). I found out from the other villagers who they were and sent an order to the village to have them caught, their feet fastened in blocks of wood to prevent their running away and brought in that state to Tabreez. The man whose servant they had robbed begged them off or I should have given them a much severer punishment than they had, as it was they had about one hundred blows each on the soles of the feet, and as they see I am not to be trifled with I hope they will leave off their mal practices. But they have been within the last few days getting drunk and fighting amongst themselves and as I was sitting down to write this letter three of them came in to complain; several of them have been wounded with daggers, one badly; I must punish some of them or we shall have no peace, not that I care much about their fighting but if the Prince hears that I keep such bad order in my villages he will give me no more or perhaps take these from me. I do not dispair because I have made nothing out of these villages this year, it was an entirely new trade to me, and I have had much to learn, besides the sheep, fruit, etc., which the villagers bring to their chief to repay him for his trouble he ought to get 20% on the revenues (taxes) of the village. And then this village has been

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